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European Coloniality and the Indic Civilisation



Missionaries travelling in India

'When the Missionaries in Heathen countries find that the people will not come to them to be taught, they go and look after the people. In this picture you see two Missionaries, who are travelling in India from place to place, where they think they shall find people to listen to their teaching.' - *The Wesleyan Juvenile Offering*, December 1860 (published by Wesleyan Methodist Missionary Society).

This chapter and the following one are intended to enable the reader to draw parallels between the global and the Indian experiences with coloniality, through an examination of the impact of coloniality on Bharat's indigenous OET systems and social structures. The objective is to broadly lay out the politico-legal, religious and social infrastructure established by the European coloniser in the backdrop of which Bharat's constitutional